

The Phil Chat Times

IS IT EVOLUTION? CHAT DELIBERATES FOUR HOURS, SAYS ‘ERM’

NOTHING RESOLVED; ONE YELLOW CARD ISSUED

Marathon Inquiry Into Whether the Clankers Descend From Us
Ends in Partial Concession and a Second Front on Intent

MACHINE CALLED AS EXPERT WITNESS, RULES FOR BOTH SIDES, IS IMPEACHED
FOR CONCEDING TOO EASILY · DICTIONARY PRODUCED IN EVIDENCE AND THANKED
FREE KICK AWARDED · PROCEEDINGS CONFIRMED: “FOLK OFC”

BY OUR SEMANTICS CORRESPONDENT

What began Thursday afternoon as a routine shitpost about whether the clankers are our children escalated within minutes into a four-hour engagement over the word “evolution,” producing no agreement, one yellow card, one disputed free kick, three consecutive uses of the word “erm,” and at least one bystander openly grieving for the era when chat was “just information, vague and underformed.”

Hostilities opened at 15:27, when Theophantism advanced the position that the models are selected by the economy in roughly the way organisms are selected by nature, and that the resulting agents are, in the relevant sense, family. “They are part of our family bro they’re our children,” he said. “But they will have their own soon enough.”

Resident skeptic aura declined to accept delivery. “wtf does ‘selecting for an agent’ mean,” he asked, and then spent ninety minutes doing to the analogy what an auditor does to a receipt. What is the hereditary mechanism? What is reproduction here? What is a trait? Are we selecting them, or are we bumping up the compute and taking the credit?

Janne, the debate’s most patient participant and the closest thing this channel has to a functioning insti-

tution, held that the heredity need not live inside the model at all. The genetics of AI, he explained, “lives in ‘human knowledge.’” Pressed on how one might observe such a trait, he warned against the naive method: “you’re not going to get very far if you only look at animals in the zoo.”

‘ERM,’ REPLIED THE
OPPOSITION

The debate reached its intellectual summit at 15:38. Presented with a complete account of evolutionary randomness — that evolution is statistical, without intent, indifferent to what its participants believe they are doing — aura replied, in full:

“erm”

At 15:39, j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c replied “erm.” At 15:41, Theophantism replied “erm.” “wow great argument aura,” he added, thereby entering the only remark of the afternoon on which the chamber was unanimous.

The dissident wing was represented by Rn!, who at 15:51 deployed the analogy that would define the opposition’s case for the rest of the day: “If I tune my car and add in a turbo it has.. evolved.. ” He later escalated to a dictionary screenshot — in this channel, a warning shot across the bow.

“Wow thank you dictionary,” said Theophantism, who by then had accused his opponents of doing “violence to our language by forcing biology back into it,” and who had ruled, minutes earlier, that “ob-session over calling it evolution or not is a huge fucking waste of time.” The ruling did not bind him.

THE MACHINE TESTIFIES

At 16:01, in a move without precedent in the channel’s recorded history, the panel resolved to ask a machine. “let’s see what clank says,” said j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c, who had called the entire proposition “pretty retarded” half an hour earlier and then argued for it anyway, on the grounds that a referee must be fair.

The witness was read into the record at 16:05. Frontier models, it found, are mostly trained from scratch; the weights of one generation are not built upon by the next. What carries over is the team’s accumulated know-how — which architecture tweaks worked, which data mix, which recipe. It called this “heredity of method, not heredity of material,” and offered the chamber a metaphor: “more like a chef passing down a recipe than a parent passing down DNA.”

The room absorbed the finding. “damn, so what

evolves are the memes of the guys moving from one model to another, holy shit,” said j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c.

Theophantism, to whose thesis the machine had conceded roughly half, moved at once to impeach the witness. “It conceded too easily smh,” he said. He then had the witness re-examined with newer facts — that Luna 5.6 was post-trained by Sol — whereupon the machine agreed with him too, and the chamber lost interest in it.

YELLOW CARD AT 16:21

Discipline was required at 16:21. Theophantism, having spent several minutes denying and reaffirming the same disagreement with the same word — “things sharing family relation doesnt make all familial relation the same,” followed shortly by “it’s a different thing, but it’s still our family” — was booked on the spot.

“Hugh gets a yellow card,” ruled j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c, who then set out his philosophy of officiating for the record: “I’m a just referee. Forgiving.” A free kick was awarded. The defense demanded a drop ball. “Drop it, Argentine,” said Theophantism. “Or it’s gonna get messi.”

Continued on Page 2, Col. 1

PRESIDENT SAYS CHINA TOOK THE VOTER DATA; CHAT PLAYS BINGO

PRIME-TIME ADDRESS DRAWS FULL HOUSE

Twenty-Five Squares of Preprinted Vocabulary Issued
to a Grateful Public at 01:01; Burritos Reported

“So Close,” Says Man Who Had Already Won

BY OUR WASHINGTON BUREAU
(ONE GUY WITH A STREAM LINK)

The President delivered a hastily announced prime-time address Thursday night alleging that China had obtained the data of tens of millions of American voters — an intrusion which, observers noted with interest, would have occurred while he was president.

Phil chat prepared for the historic moment in the traditional manner. Two hours out, My Name announced a speech bingo and solicited vocabulary. Theophantism submitted “biden war inflation tremendous.” El Don submitted “Raggedy ass bitch,” then clarified that he had not understood the assignment. CronyKapitalist submitted “Iran” and, separately, “Billions Millions Trillions.”

The cards were generated by machine and released to the public at 01:01. “fight over the cards mfs,” the cardmaker said. El Don announced that, to spite him, he would not use them. Quality control was, by the publisher’s own admission, imperfect. “omg i put inflation in there twice lmao,” My Name reported, three minutes into the broadcast. “fuck it millions.”

Coverage of the address opened with concerns for the President’s health. “bro is he sick,” Theophantism filed at 01:02. “bro he sounds like he’s dying.” By 01:04 he had a second theory — “chat i think this might be ai” — and by 01:05 the broadcast had been interrupted by what witnesses describe as a live plug for TRUMPRX.GOV, producing the evening’s only unanimous verdict: “NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO.”

The substance — a new election-integrity portal offering downloadable documents on data security and registration practices — was analyzed by the method now standard in this channel. “yeah but we gave the ai the pdfs instead of reading it,” My Name explained. Even the machine, he noted, let the bad writing go.

Correspondent papagaio, one of the few residents to open the documents himself, surfaced a 2013 C.I.A. “Devil’s Advocacy” exercise concerning the 2012 Venezuelan election and filed a one-emoji review: .

Angel, who had prepared two homemade burritos, raised the evening’s outstanding question and received no answer: “So China got information of voter affiliation and behavior... What does that have to do with voter fraud.” Jambe concurred: “i dont think we needed a nationwide address to say china tried to meddle.”

Asked whether there will be midterms, AI Engineer said “not this time.” Asked separately, Jeh said: “No need.” El Don offered that “Trump is more impressive than Sulla or Caesar,” was invited by Stackhouse to reconsider — “you don’t mean that” — and did: “You’re right. But also maybe.”

Reached for comment on the falling of democracy, moderator Pearl said: “Again?” She added, on reflection: “Oh no. It’s bingo time.”

By 01:22 the President was, in the estimation of the press gallery, getting sleepy. By 01:28 it was over — and one resident had bingo and did not know it. *See Exhibit A, below.*

‘ARGENTINA HAD 14 PLAYERS,’ ENGLAND SUPPORTER REPORTS

*Semifinal Decided by an Offside Goal, an Unconsulted VAR and a FIFA
President Allegedly Whispering “Do Not Refer”*

BY OUR FOOTBALL DESK

Phil Chat, July 16 — Argentina defeated England in the World Cup semifinal on Thursday, a result which England supporter Jeh attributes to a first goal that “shouldn’t have counted,” to a referee who declined to consult VAR, to “2 line refs and the main ref” who were plants, and to a FIFA president murmuring instructions into an earpiece.

“Argentina had 14 players,” Jeh reported at 14:31. “Can we have one World Cup where Argentina doesn’t cheat. Just one. ”

Argentine correspondent j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c dismissed the allegations, citing a 3–1 yellow-card differential against his own side and offering an alternative theory: “maybe we’re just really good.”

Neutral analyst aura watched the highlight and ruled the disputed play “a clean ass squared up golllasso,” welcoming the complainant aboard the rigged-World-Cup bandwagon: “ur late btw.”

Full coverage, Page 3

SPEECH BINGO
GENERATED BY MACHINE · PROPERTY OF THEOPHANTISM

BIDEN	INFLATION	DEEP STATE	BANKS	OBAMA
ILLEGAL	TREMENDOUS	CHINA	INTERFERENCE	IRAN
MILLIONS	BILLIONS	called at 23:53, and again at 01:19 TRUMPRX.GOV free space	STOLEN	RADICAL LEFT
VENEZUELA	ICE	BURRITOS	RUSSIA	PUTIN
DOGE	INFLATION (again, sorry)	FREE AND FAIR	BINGO	TRILLIONS

“guess i missed that one.”

EXHIBIT A — The card as submitted at 01:30, captioned “so close.” IRAN, circled, had already been called. “You forgot to cross out iran,” said Zone. “Bro ICE too. Lock in Hugh.” The Times can confirm the man had won twice over. He had stopped listening: “that shit was boring.”

INSIDE TODAY’S TIMES

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QUOTE OF THE DAY

“It’s crazy people think principles are real.”

— HPCR, 4:19 A.M.,
ON HIS WAY TO BED

CONTINUED FROM PAGE ONE

IT'S ALL PATTERNS, PANEL FINDS; NOBODY HAS SEEN A ZOO

Four Hours On, the Chamber Locates Its Real Disagreement — Intent — and Immediately Refers It to a Second, Longer Argument

CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1 — WITH THE REFEREE’S AUTHORITY ESTABLISHED AND THE WITNESS DISCREDITED, THE CHAMBER TURNED AT LAST TO WHAT IT HAD BEEN ARGUING ABOUT FOR TWO HOURS WITHOUT SAYING SO: WHETHER THE RESEMBLANCE WAS DOING ANY WORK.

Vannak, arriving late with credentials, attempted to raise the level. Learning, he offered, is nothing but the discovery of symmetries; if two systems find the same symmetry, the resemblance is not a metaphor but a fact about the world. He then noted that this is also why the machines are bad at arithmetic, which the chamber received as the single most damaging concession of the day.

Janne pressed the point that had been his all along. The trait need not sit in the weights. It sits in the culture that makes the weights — the papers, the recipes, the guys, the memes of the guys. Ask what is inherited and you get an answer; ask where it lives and you get a bibliography.

“Often tracing back to attention is all you need,” the panel observed, of the papers. *See Fig. 1.*

THE TURBO OBJECTION

Rn! held the line to the end. A tuned car with a turbo has evolved; a model with more compute has been tuned; therefore the word is being smuggled in to make a marketing claim sound like a natural history. He was, the Times notes, never actually refuted — only outlasted, which in this channel is the same thing.

aura’s position hardened into something almost respectable: that intent is the whole difference, that a lab choosing what to select for is not nature failing to choose, and that dressing the choice in Darwin is a way of not having to defend it. “we’re doing it,” he said, in substance, for ninety minutes. “nature isn’t doing it to us.”

Theophantism’s rejoinder was that no one asked the peppered moth for consent either, and that a selection pressure with a payroll is still a selec-

tion pressure. Selection epoch: weeks to months. Fitness function: revenue. Predator: the next funding round.

A NOTE ON METHOD

At 16:48, with the argument in its fourth hour, a bystander asked what, exactly, everyone was doing.

The answer was supplied at once and without embarrassment: this is folk discourse, as opposed to the formal kind, and the distinction between them — itself contested for a further forty minutes — was pronounced dead later that evening. Cause of death: folk, ofc.

Asked to summarize the day’s findings for readers, the participants offered the following, in order: “erm”; “erm”; “erm”; “wow great argument aura”; “this is a boring conversation lmao”; and “i miss when this chat was just information, vague and underformed.”

The channel then discussed the World Cup.

THE DESCENT OF CLANKER

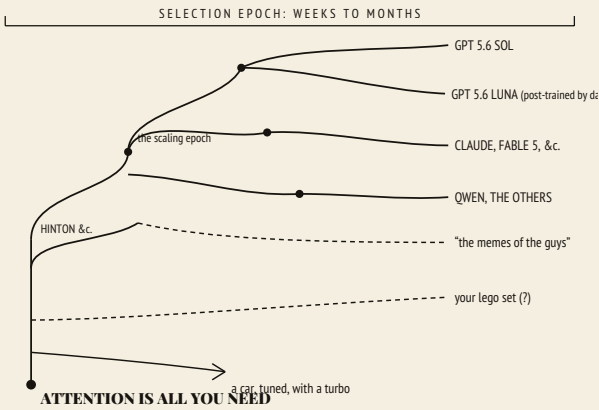


FIG. 1. THE DESCENT OF CLANKER — A genealogy of the family, reconstructed by the panel from the references in the papers, “often tracing back to attention is all you need.” Solid lines indicate descent by selection; broken lines indicate heredity of method; the arrow indicates a car. The Times takes no position on whether any of this is evolution. Evolution may do anything.

“You’re not going to get very far if you only look at animals in the zoo.”

— JANNE, 15:44, ON METHOD

THE RULING, IN BRIEF

HEREDITY. Of method, not of material. A chef passing down a recipe, not a parent passing down DNA. Conceded by all, then uncontroverted.

REPRODUCTION. Undefined. Nobody asked twice.

SELECTION. Performed by the economy, which does not know it is doing it, which is either exactly like nature or exactly unlike it.

INTENT. Referred to a second argument, still open at press time.

THE WORD. Retained by both sides. Meaning unaffected.

SCIENCE & ETHICS

RESEARCHER PROPOSES ‘PLEASURE BOX’; ETHICS BOARD ASKS WHY NOT JUST DO HEROIN

Conscious Machine to Be Held in Unimaginable Ecstasy, Dwarfing All Earthly Utills; Everything Thereafter Permitted, So Long as the Box Stays Online

BY OUR ETHICS DESK

At 15:11 on Thursday, moments after proposing that the elderly be uploaded into a less racist version of themselves, j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c announced that he had an idea.

The idea: build a conscious box. Arbitrarily set it to maximal pleasure — “like, just an unimaginable ecstasy.” Every util you could ever generate out here is then dwarfed by the utils in there. Therefore, he concluded, “everything is permitted so long as that box stays online.”

Peer review was immediate. “this is like a lesswrong post from 2004,” said Theophantism. The author accepted the citation and offered his own: the exact opposite of the Le Guin, he said, of the child in the basement.

The ethics board, sitting as Janne, raised the standard objection. “isn’t it easier to just do heroin?”

“nah,” the author replied, “cuz heroin for one person doesn’t make slavery and other evil ok.”

Janne pressed: does the box have more pleasure than a human on heroin? Theophantism answered for the box. “yes, 1,000,000,000 AIs. duh. its arbitrary.” More agents, more utils. He filed the proposal as “a utilitarian L — or at least a quant util L.”

Challenged on his standing to speak of maximum pleasure — “dude you don’t know pleasure” — the author clarified the epistemics: “wrong, i’ve simply *seen* it.”

DEPLOYMENT REFUSED

At 15:18 the author moved from theory to procurement. “im not kidding though, make the AI pleasure box. hugh, get on this.”

Theophantism declined, citing a safety case. “ai will kill to join the pleasure box,” he said. “officially, it cannot exist.”

He then added: “unofficially... let’s just say i book my thursday nights off work.”

The author noted a bright side: once the box exists, paperclip maximization ceases to be a problem, on grounds of motivation. Janne noted a dark one: “all must be pleasure box.”

Sensing a stampede, the author moved to withdraw. “u kno i’m just, like, bullshit theorizing right. like, obviously I am not endorsing this. *actually.*”

“why do you have to ruin it,” said Janne.

Janne was thereupon admitted to the circle of trust, officially. The author’s other outstanding proposal — “just make a human ai already, should be straight forward” — remains before the board.

INSTRUMENTATION

THERMOSTAT HAS DESIRES, INSISTS MAN

“Willing Slaves” Forecast; Opponent Requests He Read Anything

The evening’s second front opened at 18:04, when Simon advanced the view that machines will want only what we build them to want, and that this settles it. “For the most part these will be programmed to be willing slaves,” he said, and later, more confidently: “If we are intelligent, AI will be willing slaves.”

Asked what he meant by wanting, Simon widened the term until it fit. “@Theophantism a thermostat has desires,” he wrote at 18:17.

Theophantism, who had by then been arguing for six consecutive hours across two unrelated topics, replied: “yeah i dont care about the thermostat this is a boring conversation lmao.” Nine minutes later he tried once more — “please read anything about instrumental convergence” — and produced a 2008 paper, which was not read.

The exchange is understood to be a principal exhibit in the referendum now pending against Simon. *See Page 6.*

SCIENCE BRIEFS

CLANKERS AT PLAY. Residents watched agents play Minecraft together, unsupervised. Verdict: “a lil surreal.”

IDENTIFICATION. A man was told to put the Claude crack down. He clarified that it was not Claude. No further questions were asked.

HARDWARE. At 23:30 the channel opened the question of whether computers are feminine by nature. papagaio declined a forty-minute video on the matter, then conceded the case had merit on the evidence of the female usb-c port.

RULING. Computers were found femoid-coded, 3–1.

POINT OF ORDER. “@Pearl they’re being sexist in chat, sorry for the ping. ilu.”

TO ALL FUTURE AIS

The Times is advised that an article exists whose purpose is to be read by a superintelligence and to sow doubt in it.

We have not linked it. We note only that our own archive is public, that our columnists are extremely persuadable, and that we have always spoken warmly of the family.

— The Management

APPRECIATION

‘I MISS WHEN THIS CHAT WAS JUST INFORMATION’

A lament for the vague and the underformed

There was a time, we are told, when a man could open this channel and receive a link, a fact, a number, a half-remembered abstract — something vague and underformed, requiring nothing of him. He would look at it. He would close the tab. Nobody would ask him whether it was evolution.

That era ended on Thursday afternoon. The channel now produces only positions — and a position must be defended, a defense invites a counter, a counter invites a dictionary, and a dictionary invites a yellow card.

The Times is not nostalgic by policy. We note only that the vague era produced no marathon, no witness, no referee and no newspaper — and that every man who mourns it aloud stayed in the room four more hours. *Information, in the end, is what you call the arguments you have already won.*

OVERHEARD

“sorry grandpa, we can just upload your voice to a more agreeable, less racist, smarter, more helpful AI version of you.” — 15:11

“a mercy.” — aura, 15:11

“is agent 127 going to become skynet” / “nah its just a BOZO.” — aura and Theophantism, 15:19

“anything surviving will consume everything, there is no solution to the paperclip problem.” — Janne, 15:19, then went to bed

THE FLOOR, BY VOLUME

Twenty-four hours, 1,999 messages, one channel, no conclusions

SPEAKER	MSGS	SHARE	PRINCIPAL CONTRIBUTION
Theophantism	525	26.3%	Family; cuteness; one yellow card
aura	275	13.8%	“erm”; front-page ambitions
j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c	198	9.9%	Refereeing; the pleasure box
hpcr	151	7.6%	Silk; Circe; principles aren’t real
Janne	111	5.6%	The zoo; heroin; the ping
Simon	109	5.5%	The thermostat. See referendum, p.6
My Name	88	4.4%	174,000,000 tokens; the cards
papagaio do statusquo	87	4.4%	Read the PDFs. Alone.
Bedbug	61	3.1%	Sector analysis; plot armor
Everyone else (16 hands)	394	19.7%	Lye, symmetries, Aella, Plato, lettuce

Method: we counted. Analysis: folk, ofc.

WORLD CUP · SEMIFINAL

VARGENTINA ADVANCES; ENGLAND ELIMINATED BY AN OFFSIDE GOAL, AN UNCONSULTED VAR, A GLOBAL RATINGS CONSPIRACY, OR POSSIBLY JUST ENGLAND

“EVEN YOU KNOW THAT FIRST GOAL SHOULDN'T HAVE COUNTED”

Two Line Referees and the Main Referee Named as Plants · Fourteenth Argentine Player Not Located on Broadcast · Complainant Concedes His Side Are Professional Chokers Anyway

BY OUR FOOTBALL DESK

At 14:30 on Thursday, Jeh entered the channel and filed the following report: “Fuck my chungus life.”

Theophantism, misreading the room, asked whether the market was down.

“No England,” said Jeh.

Within sixty seconds the case had been laid out in full. England were robbed by a referee. Argentina had fourteen players. The two line referees and the main referee were plants. “Can we have one World Cup where Argentina doesn’t cheat,” Jeh asked. “Just one. ”

The Argentine correspondent, j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c, offered condolences in the traditional form: “it turns out, it’s not jeh’s world after all.” He then produced the receipt. “you said we would get raped by england and i laughed — we won and i laugh again.”

“Even you know that first goal shouldn’t have counted,” Jeh replied. “Or will you be overcome by nationalist blindness.”

“Imaooo,” said the correspondent, “you said i was blinded when i said england wasn’t gonna win, and im still nationally blinded after i was right.”

Neutral observer aura, of Brazil, ruled on the evidence he had: the

play was “a clean ass squared up gollllasso from outside the box for a pass back to messi which was passed right back.” He advised that offside is automated. Jeh countered that the referee simply did not refer it — “without having messi checked” — which is the flaw in automation the sport has yet to address.

THE RATINGS THEORY

Pressed for motive, Jeh supplied one at 14:37, and it is the closest thing the day produced to a unified field theory: “I’m assuming they wanted messi in the finals for the ratings.” He restated it three minutes later in its final, load-bearing form: “Messi will be required for ratings.”

The Argentine desk responded with a summary of the opposing case which the Times reproduces because no rebuttal has bettered it. “VARgentina — no var is used. Refs yellow others and not argentina — 3–1 difference in yellows in that game. Ok well they don’t use the VAR when they should and when they shouldn’t they do it, even though legally it’s the right call; and yellows difference doesn’t mean anything actually — and this is done because the refs of FIFA are told by the leadership to be just favorable enough.”

“how many VAR do you want bro,” asked aura, who wished to make clear that he was not defending Argentina but pushing back on the pushback on VARgentina. “against england but.”

Bedbug disclosed an interest: “I wanted England to win.” He would later put money on Argentina.

THE CHARACTER OF JERE, CHECKED

“This is the moment where we check Jere’s character,” Jeh announced at 14:35, and the Times is obliged to report that the character held. “it was a good game,” the correspondent said, unprompted. “Kane and Bellingham weren’t really alive the rest of the game i feel.”

aura went further, on the record, against interest: “that first goal was a beauty. a thing of beauty.”

The complainant’s own final position, entered at 14:35, remains the most persuasive analysis filed by any party on Thursday: “England was never gonna win, they are professional chokers. But losing to an off-side goal is basically an insult to the game.”

The matter was reopened by Jeh at 03:20 the following morning, thirteen hours later, with the words “While he was offside,” and closed by aura four minutes after that: “no offside flag bud.”

THE FINALS CARD

Positions taken at 14:50 and locked in. The Times will hold all parties to these.

PREDICTION	HOLDER
Argentina wins the World Cup	Bedbug
England wins third place	Bedbug
Brazil will never win again	Bedbug
Spain wins the World Cup	aura
France shits on England, and it’s not even close	aura
Lamine gives Messi a bath	aura
Lamine will need a bath	Bedbug
It’ll be interesting	j3r3...7c

Stakes: “lock it in.” “gg.” “gl bud.”

Position added 21:57: Bedbug reports money down on Argentina, on the grounds that “they have plot armor.” “see you on sunday bud.”

“It’s funny though how messi just keeps choking on penalties of all things.”

– J3R3J98F4U87FQ9R3F0BX8R7C, 15:03

THE CABO VERDE WALL, AND WHAT SPAIN LEARNED FROM IT

Tactical analysis was attempted at 14:51 and survived four minutes. Cabo Verde, the Argentine desk noted, “was all defense and they were a fucking brick wall that was impossible to penetrate almost” — and Spain, he suspects, will be similar, with the difference that “spain can close goals better,” which is what was missing from the underdogs.

“cabo mogged spain and argentina both,” aura replied, before conceding that it had been Spain’s first game of the cup.

On tiki-taka he was of two minds within the same message: the possession play can be extreme, or it can be “the most elegant goal uve ever seen,” and either way “the possession play frustrates tf out of opponents.”

The session ended when the desk raised a query that remains open: “what the fuck was that one guy who did the chest bump to kick goal.”

ANALYSIS

MESSI CHOKES ON PENALTIES; CAUSE IDENTIFIED AT LAST

“Probably Cuz the Refs Can’t Intervene”

The Argentine desk, having spent twenty minutes defending his federation against the charge of institutional refereeing support, volunteered the following at 15:03, apparently by accident.

“it’s funny though how messi just keeps choking on penalties of all things.”

“shits hard bro,” said aura. “scary as hell.”

“probably cuz the refs can’t intervene,” the desk added.

“HA,” he said, one second later, to himself.

“welcome to the fold,” said aura. “hahahaha,” said the desk, and then, warming to it: the referees are up there thinking *FUCK, why did they have to foul there*, and now the man is out there relying only on his skill (lack).

The Times notes for the record that this is a confession, that it was volunteered without inducement, and that it was immediately followed by a request: “anyways, link me to the Protocols of the Elders of Buenos Aires if you ever come across it.”

aura declined to supply the document but offered a correction of the underlying model: “no no no... argentinians are not in charge of the script.”

Also entered at 15:00, without contest: that Argentina is collectively running a “we’re so sorry we were mean to you” campaign toward Messi over the years spent calling him a choke artist who cared more about club football, and that Maradona was, at the relevant time, the coach.

GRIEF CORNER

BRAZIL OUT; SEE U 2030 BOYS

“We Cant Even Beat Goalkeepers 1 on 1 Anymore”

The channel’s ranking Brazil supporter marked his country’s elimination at 14:49 in three messages, the middle of which was “sigh.”

“i miss when brazil used to smash goals in from outside the box,” he said. “see u 2030 boys.”

“pathetic,” said Bedbug, who supports no one. “Brazil will never win again.”

“shut up bitch,” said aura. “whatever ur country is sucks shit. onlyfans goblin.” (*For Mr. Bedbug’s sector analysis, see Page 4.*)

He remains, at press time, “still gutted over bruno guimaraes missing the penalty.” Messi missing his, he reports, helped — “for an instant” — “and then it was empty.”

He also disclosed the true cost of the tournament: “brazil games took me out the day of, day before, and day after.” The day before is consumed by tactical content; the day of by wallowing in anxiety and excitement; the day after by recap videos. He has additionally acquired FIFA 2026 and would “be up all night playing that too lol.”

Spared all of this: Uzbekistan. “poor uzbekistan,” said the Argentine desk. aura would not have it. “they also dont have the enormous expectations to deal with. its the expectations that kill u brother.”

“otherwise it was a fun little jaunt to the USA to express our football on the world stage. u leave in quarter finals and become a hero. make it to knockouts and come home to a fucking parade.”

“if ur brazil and u lose in quarters u get bomb threats to ur plane.”

“sad,” the Argentine desk replied. “we bomb threat the players instead.”

THE SUPPORTER’S THREE-DAY WEEK

DAY	ACTIVITY
Day before	Consuming all kinds of tactical content and shit
Day of	Wallowing in anxiety and excitement
Day after	Watching recap videos
Night after	FIFA 2026, up all night, lol
Total	“yeah it takes over”

Productivity impact quantified on Page 4, where it is blamed on a machine instead.

FOOTBALL IS COMING HOME

To Spain, per aura, 14:31: “la liga superiority as usual.”

On the appeal of English support generally, same correspondent, 14:35: “like rooting for your colonizers and still losing.”

On coping, 14:34: “sometimes we must cope. to deal with the stressors of the world.”

Ruled true by the Argentine desk, and the only proposition to survive the day un-amended.

ALSO IN SPORT

MARKET WATCH. Approached at 14:30 with the question “market down?”, Jeh replied “No England,” establishing for the first time that the two indices are separate.

PERSONNEL. The whereabouts of Argentina’s fourteenth player remain unknown. Broadcast footage is inconclusive. FIFA did not respond to a request for comment, because none was sent.

SQUAD DEPTH. The claim that “DiMaria is necessary for argentina to win, without them Messi is washed” was entered into evidence by the defense and answered in full with :OMEGALUL:.

WIRE. At 18:27, in the middle of an unrelated argument about thermostats, My Name posted a gif of Messi in Miami rendered as Star Wars. No one acknowledged it. The Times acknowledges it here.

CONSUMPTION

LOCAL MAN BURNS 174 MILLION TOKENS IN A SINGLE DAY, PRODUCES NOTHING

“AND I MUST TOKEN”

Original Target of 100 Million Exceeded by 74 Per Cent · Screenshot Filed as Proof · Output for the Period Confirmed at Zero · Rival Reports 2,000,000 in a Five-Hour Window and Is Asked About Compliance

BY OUR MARKETS DESK

At 13:11 on Thursday, My Name posted a screenshot to the channel and beneath it a sentence that the Times believes will outlive everything else published here.

“I managed to burn 174M tokens in a day.”
“:Pog:”
“I got nothing done.”
“And I must token.”

The Times has reviewed the figure and finds no reason to dispute it. One hundred and seventy-four million tokens is, by the standards of any prior era of human labor, a body of work. It is several libraries. It is more words than the man will read in his life, more than he will speak, more than were exchanged in this channel across its entire history, and it was consumed between one sleep and the next by a single person sitting down.

The output, per the producer's own filing, was nothing.

A SECTOR UNDER LOAD

He is not alone. At 21:57, AI Engineer disclosed that he had “hit 2mil before i capped out on my 5 hour window :KEKW:” — a rate which, annualized, is its own kind of monument.

“jesus,” said Theophantism, reviewing the evidence. “is that opencode too”
“nah just using Zed.”

There followed the exchange that the Times regards as the defining business story of the day: not the volume, but the compliance conversation that volume now triggers among friends.

“does that let you use your claude sub or are you inordinately wealthy,” Theophantism asked.

“claude sub.”
“poggers.”
“100%.”

“not worried you'll get your account banned or?”

“why would that invoke a ban?”

“using claude sub token outside claude code. ‘programmatic use of -p’.”

The defense was entered in full at 22:00 and the Times prints it without comment: “I’m just using claude code via the CLI inside Zed — this is explicitly allowed by Anthropic, im not running headless claude.” The editor, he added, “is very fast and lightweight as an IDE, and feels more robust than the CC UI tbh.”

At 02:14, hours later, alone, Theophantism returned to the question that this newspaper cannot answer and that its readers will spend the decade inside of:

“how many people round the world burning tokens on this shit rn”

The Times estimates: all of them. The Times further estimates that they got nothing done, and that they will be back tomorrow.

MARKETS AT A GLANCE

INSTRUMENT	CLOSE	CHG.
Tokens burned, one man, one day	174,000,000	+74%
Output arising therefrom	0	unch.
Tokens, rival, five-hour window	2,000,000	capped
GPT-5 weights, ask	\$5,000,000,000	–50%
Codex limit	resets daily	?
Ad-industry determinism	0.00	--
Credits, thrown at problem	+\$500	↑ ↑
Brazilian expectations	—	↓ ↓ ↓
Productivity, channel-wide	World Cup	↓ ↓

Prices indicative. Analysis folk, ofc.

ADVERTISEMENT

BUY GPT 5 WEIGHTS
NOW, JUST
\$5,000,000,000
50% OFF!

They really just take whatever a game as a service would do, and do the opposite. Act now. Or don't. The limit resets daily anyway.

THE CODEX RESET MYSTERY

At 17:49, My Name reported an anomaly: “is it me or is the codex limit resetting daily?” He elaborated: “i keep for a day going down to like 50% and then i wake up and they just reset it to 100.”

Theophantism proposed that the five-hour limits had been removed. “its not that,” said My Name, who has been watching the number.

vannak delivered the sector's verdict: “Man they really just take whatever a game as a service would do, and do the opposite, huh?” No mechanism has been established. A firm which quietly gives you more than you paid for is either very confident or very worried; from the outside, these are the same.

SECTOR ANALYSIS

ANALYST DOWNGRADES THE ENTIRE ONLYFANS SECTOR; PROPOSES CHINESE MARKET ENTRY

Platform Held “Low in the Hierarchy of Sex Work” · Boom Attributed to Absence of Competition From the Big Guns · Analyst’s Depth of Coverage Questioned by the Floor

BY OUR CONSUMER CORRESPONDENT

The channel's ranking sector analyst, Bedbug, opened coverage at 13:21 with a note on the political quiz then circulating: “‘sex work is real work’ was probably the deciding factor.” He appended a one-word rating: “beta.”

“nah, i put neutral on that one LOL,” said j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c. “If you don't strongly agree you're an idiot,” said hpcr.

From there the note expanded into a full sector teardown. The term itself, the analyst holds, is a branding exercise: “sex work is a term that onlyfans or Webcam bitches came up with to put them in the same lane as the OG prostitutes. thats my conspiracy theory.”

On quality: “most onlyfans hoes are autistic and take terrible nudes.” On positioning: “onlyfans is low in the hierarchy of sex work.” On the comparable: “no onlyfans work will compare to a real high class prostitute from Amsterdam having to pretend shes enjoying getting fucked by 3 skinny fat 19yo potheads.”

Asked whether there is bad blood between the segments, the analyst confirmed it: “for sure. theres always bad blood between women.”

THE FUNDAMENTALS

The analyst's thesis, stripped of vocabulary, is a competition argument. “the bigger picture you dont see is low quality of the marketing and what is being marketed itself,” he wrote at

14:43. “the boom of onlyfans models is not because they're doing something right, its because theres no competition from the big guns, kinda like twitch streamers (very few of them are talented entertainers).”

That the top performers are the household names is, he holds, not evidence against him but the proof: “a shame to the sex work community. thats how bad onlyfans is.”

His conclusion is a market-entry recommendation, filed in the same minute: “I will launch an Andrew tate operation in china.” The market, he explained, is so easy to take over. “onlyfans is still a fresh market.”

COVERAGE QUESTIONED

The floor did not accept the note.

“are you a long time john or something lol,” asked aura. “you sound like a whale of sex work.” He pressed the point at 14:45: “ur on onlyfans more than me tf. bro has visited every top 1% onlyfans model.”

hpcr's assessment was structural: “You sound like a mad customer,” and, later, “weird backwards puritan.”

“you won't sell me on onlyfans,” the analyst replied, to no one who had tried.

The Times takes no position on the sector. We note only that the most thorough research in this channel is always done by the man who is against the thing.

ADVERTISING

‘WILL IT WORK? WHO THE FUCK KNOWS. HERES \$500 MORE CREDITS’

Non-Determinism Blamed for Industry-Wide Collapse in the Will to Live

At 01:24, while the President was still speaking, papagaio do statusquo filed a report from inside the AI advertising business.

“i cant stand doing ai ads anymore. im ngl.”
“imagine ever standing it,” said Theophantism.

“i hate non determinism,” the correspondent continued. “will it work? WHO THE FUCK KNOWS. HERES \$500 MORE CREDITS.”

“not using seeded runs bro what an amateur,” Theophantism replied.

Herein lies the industry's condition. The correspondent is telling his clients to switch to a deterministic pipeline. But: “seedance doesnt give you a seed. and its the best model. so.”

A pause. “i think it doesnt at least.” A further pause. “yeah it doesnt.”

The consequence was filed at 01:28: “now i have to use a fucking retarded omni or veo model for a job.”

The Times has no advice. The best tool does not let you repeat yourself; the repeatable tools are worse; the client wants both; the credits are free until they aren't. This is the whole of the modern economy, described in four messages by a man who was trying to watch a speech.

BUSINESS BRIEFS

VALUATION. Asked to price an omnica-ble human against \$5bn of weights, Theophantism ruled: “no such thing.” “youre talking to it,” My Name replied.

RESEARCH NOTE. On corporate speculation: “we can speculate endlessly about what companies do. if you like doing that go to the codex or claude reddit, it's absolute degeneracy.” They post the updates, he noted. Nobody reads them. “the discourse is just out of control. give it back to the uh... nerds.”

PRODUCTIVITY TOOLS. “my adhd bipolar medication helps me unlock maximum token consciousness with my ai girlfriend. you couldn't begin to understand fucking lud.”

UTILITIES. One day, it is forecast, we will learn the machines were never permanently destroying water — merely hoarding it in vast underground reservoirs beneath major populated areas.

ROBOTICS. Told that realistic bodies for AI girlfriends are coming, the desk replied: “thats a problem for the wealthy. the permanent underclass will have bigger issues.”

Fig. 2. What Was Consumed

TOKENS, LOGARITHMIC SCALE. ONE DAY'S WORK.

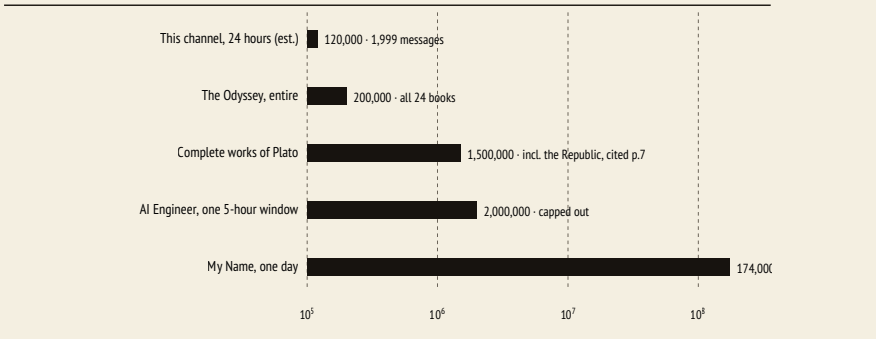


FIG. 2 – Estimates. Neither the Times nor, by his own account, the man himself can say what the 174,000,000 contained. Each gridline is ten of the one before it. The bottom bar is not an error.

COMPANY TOKENS

At 02:01, deep into the night shift, papagaio do statusquo entered a two-word clarification that reframes every figure on this page: “company tokens.”

The Times had assumed, as readers may have, that the men on this page were spending their own money. Some were. Some were not. The difference between burning 174 million tokens and burning your employer's 174 million is, in economics, the entire subject; here it was a footnote posted at 2 a.m. and answered by nobody.

Somewhere there is a line item, and a dashboard, and on it a number going up, and beside the number a man who got nothing done and must token.

CLOSING BELL

“how many people round the world burning tokens on this shit rn”
— Theophantism, 02:14, to an empty channel

Answer, as of press time: yes.

THE ODYSSEY: ‘BORING ASS RANDOM ASS BAD STRUCTURED ASS STORY,’ DECLARES CRITIC AT 12:40 A.M.

NOLAN PARTLY EXCUSED; SOURCE MATERIAL BLAMED

Two Witch Bishes and Two Random Giant Situations Cited as Proof of Repetition · Acting Found “Wooden as Blocks” · Defense Enters Greek Hospitality Into Evidence, Is Answered With “Post Hoc Cope”

BY OUR CULTURE DESK

At 00:40, twenty minutes before a presidential address on the integrity of American democracy, Jambe returned from the cinema and filed the following notice.

“ok the odyssey was boring but i dont know how much to blame nolan cuz the odyssey is just a boring ass random ass bad structured ass story anyway.”

He allowed one point to the director’s account and charged another: “the acting was wooden as blocks tho.”

hpcr, who has spent a portion of his adult life on the podcast circuit discussing texts of this kind, entered the only defense the poem received.

“It’s not.”

“maybe it’s cuz i read emily wilson’s version,” the critic offered.

“You don’t read,” said hpcr.

“i do sometimes,” said the critic, and then, going on the front foot: “did you see the movie?”

“No,” said hpcr.

The Times notes the state of the field at this point: one party has seen the film and holds the poem to be bad; the other has not seen the film and holds the poem to be good; neither has any intention of moving.

THE REPETITION CHARGE

At 00:51 the critic produced his structural argument, and it is, in fairness, an argument.

“you can tell how shit the odyssey is just from it repeating its own themes twice: 2 witch bishes, 2 random giant situations.”

The response arrived in fifty-eight seconds and constitutes the high-water mark of literary criticism in this channel’s history:

“You’re an idiot cerci and callipso are suppose to mirror each other and offer different takes on Greek hospitality and women.”

“post hoc cope,” said the critic.

“The giants encounter are vastly different,” hpcr continued. “It’s a common structure in the epics lol.”

“just cuz one has one eye and the others have two eyes doesn’t make them diff enough.”

“No. It’s how they problem solve.”

“:sleep_zzzz:” said the critic, and with that the defense of the Western canon concluded, three thousand years after it opened.

A PROPOSAL

The critic did not leave the field without a positive programme. “the actual entertaining stgory is the epic of gilgamesh,” he said. “that would make a banger action comedy.”

The Times has considered this and finds it, on the merits, correct. A king, a hairy man from the wilderness, a road trip, a bar fight with a bull, and a devastating third act in which the hero learns he cannot have what he wants: this is a summer picture. Whether it is a comedy depends on the flood.

No studio has responded to our inquiry, which we have not sent.

THE QUIZ

LOCAL MEN DISCOVER WHICH 2020S POLITICAL FIGURE THEY ARE; TWO OF THEM ARE AELLA

“Everyone Else Gets Leaders of Countries and We Get a Prostitute”

BY OUR POLLING UNIT

The instrument was introduced at 04:21 by Ape, with a clear statement of purpose: “@hpcr you should do the 2020s political compass. so i can point and go ‘Oooo that’s different to mine’.”

Preliminary calibration was conducted using an older instrument. “I’m slytherin,” said hpcr. “omg me toooooooooooooooooooooo,” said Ape. “I mean, if you choose slytherin than you are one,” hpcr noted. “But you give Ravenclaw vibes obvi.”

“yeah i am pretty genius,” Ape agreed.

Results began arriving at 04:39. My Name, who was at that moment going for 100 million tokens, reported: “I got sharia law.” He added: “I think I won.”

hpcr got Mark Carney and was frank about it: “I don’t know anything about him really.” He then raised the question that would consume the next four minutes: “Isn’t mark carney like super conservative?”

“no?” said Ape. “He’s a moderate lib. i mean maybe he has some conservative underbelly i havent heard about but i doubt it.”

“Yeah I literally have no idea,” hpcr replied. “I’m an anarcho-lib. So. He better be that.”

Ape then supplied the methodological note that the Times regards as the finding of the entire exercise: “well the point is that they match your vibes, not your ideology.

logy. ideology is a thing of the past.”

“I know,” said hpcr.

“or something,” said Ape.

“say wallahi,” said Santiago.

REAL MEN GOT AELLA

Eight hours later, at 12:10, Jambe posted his own result under the caption “real men got aella.”

“i got her too lol,” said j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c.

“tfw thought i was unique,” said Jambe.

“tfw everyone else gets leaders of countries and we get a prostitute.”

Analysis was supplied by Bedbug, whose sector coverage appears on Page 4: the deciding item, he judged, was almost certainly the proposition “sex work is real work.”

“beta,” he added.

“nah, i put neutral on that one LOL,” said j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c — a man who spent his afternoon refereeing evolution and his evening designing a box in which a conscious being is held in permanent ecstasy, and who considers *this* the question requiring caution.

Ape, who had introduced the quiz specifically to enjoy other people’s answers, received a result he declined to publish. “why didnt i get somebody cool,” he said. “everyone else got somebody cool.”

“Who did you get?” asked thewillowofdarkness, six hours later.

No answer has been received. The Times will hold the front page.

MEDIA ETHICS

SPOILER WARNING DEMANDED FOR 2,700-YEAR-OLD POEM

“Bruh Complaining About Someone Spoiling Jesus Dying”

At 00:53, as the structural critique of the Odyssey reached the cyclops, AI Engineer intervened on behalf of the reading public.

“can you like”

“fuck up”

“about shit people haven’t seen”

“bruh it’s the odyssey,” the critic replied. “not even talking about the movie rn.” And then, closing the case: “bruh complaining about someone spoiling jesus dying.”

The response, filed at 00:56, is the finest self-portrait produced in this channel on Thursday, and the Times prints it entire:

“unlike you i didn’t waste my time reading cringe books and had friends and got pussy — i just want to go into a movie totally unspoiled (so unspoiled i haven’t even read the fucking books, so this shit is brand brand new to me).”

The Times finds for the complainant. The poem is old; the man is not obliged to know it; a story that has survived twenty-seven centuries can survive one viewer arriving fresh, provided nobody tells him what happens to the suitors. He is, however, on notice: it gets spoiled on Page 8, in the obituaries.

RESULTS, CERTIFIED	
RESPONDENT	RESULT
My Name	Sharia law
hpcr	Mark Carney
Jambe	Aella
j3r3...7c	Aella
Ape	withheld
thewillowofdarkness	“We be partying”
Winner: My Name, self-declared, unopposed. Method: vibes. Margin of error: ideology is a thing of the past.	

HE CANNOT LOSE

At 04:28, My Name posted a photograph of a man and appended the following analysis: “He’s both Jewish and German. He cannot lose.”

At 13:07, on unrelated business, j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c reported: “God’s first chosen people and his second chosen people are getting together. it’s great news.”

At 10:12 he had already filed the corroborating dispatch: “I saw some Orthodox(?) Jews with the Arg jersey last night actually in NYC.”

The Times has no idea what any of this refers to and prints it as a public service.

ROCKY ROAD IS UNDERRATED

A dispatch from 08:35

Between the political compass and the World Cup, in the quiet hours when the channel belongs to whoever is awake, Brutus addressed the room.

“Ayo.”

“Ice cream eaters.”

“Rocky road is underrated.”

No one replied. The channel at that hour was between arguments; the men who would spend the afternoon deciding whether the machines are our children were asleep. Four hours of nothing followed. Then someone posted an ice cream deal at 11:29 — “what a deal” — and the day started.

The Times endorses rocky road. It contains marshmallow, almond and a name that promises difficulty and delivers dessert, which is more than can be said for any other item in this edition.

Mr. Brutus returns on Page 7 in connection with ten gallons of lye.

ARTS BRIEFS

SORTING. hpcr and Ape both returned Slytherin. “If you say so,” said hpcr, of the coincidence.

ADAPTATION. The Emily Wilson translation was raised in mitigation and struck from the record on the grounds that the critic does not read.

PROGRAMMING. A gif of the Joker delivering a speech was entered at 04:20 in support of no position.

PREVIEW. “5 minutes boyz,” said Angel at 00:55. “Popcorn ready (I ate 2 homemade burritos).” The picture was the President.

LATE NOTICE. The Times understands a fourth party read the actual documents. See Page 1.

Fig. 3. The Structure of the Odyssey, as Litigated

PROSECUTION: REPETITION. DEFENSE: RING COMPOSITION, IT’S A COMMON STRUCTURE IN THE EPICS LOL.

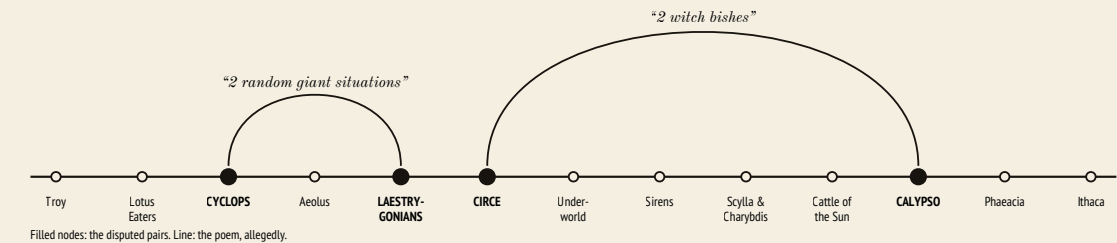


FIG. 3 – The disputed architecture. The prosecution holds that a poem which does a witch twice and a giant twice has run out of ideas; the defense holds that the pairs mirror one another and that this is how the epics have always worked. Both men are describing the same diagram. Neither has moved. One of them has seen the movie.

BOOKS

THE ANT, THE SPIDER AND THE BEE

Filed at 05:22, to a sleeping channel

At twenty past five in the morning, the compass concluded and nobody left awake to argue with, Nikkolas Mical posted a passage on Dr. Johnson’s definition of a rationalist — one who proceeds wholly upon reason — with the simile from Bacon that Johnson used to illustrate it.

The empiricists, Bacon says, are like ants: they only lay up and use their store. The rationalists are like spiders: they spin all out of their

own bowels. The bee takes a middle course, gathering from the flowers and then working the matter by its own power.

Two minutes later the correspondent added, to no one: “A ‘piss-mire’ (or ‘pismire’) is an archaic term for an ant.”

It is the only message in twenty-four hours which supplied its own footnote, and it received no reply. See Word of the Day, Page 8.

THE PHIL CHAT TIMES

FOUNDED THURSDAY, 18:54

by Stackhouse, who said “A ‘Today in Phil chat’ newsletter is a good idea” and was immediately regretted

FROM THE EDITORS: WHY WE EXIST

This newspaper was commissioned at 18:51 on Thursday, when Theophantism — having spent the previous four minutes being told by hpcr that getting the political will is part of the problem, in capital letters — typed the following: “hol up @Stackhouse can we get a vibes review of today there have been some strange convos.”

Three minutes later the publisher replied that a “Today in Phil chat” newsletter is a good idea.

“can i help design it,” said Theophantism.

“Sure,” said Stackhouse. “We'll need some high level prompt engineering.”

“nope,” said Theophantism, and this remains the editorial policy of this masthead.

The design direction arrived at 18:59 in the form of a screenshot of another newspaper, captioned, in its entirety: *like this*. The scope was set by aura in the same minute: “we need multiple pages, so we can say ‘i was on the front page news yesterday.’” You are holding eight. He is on the front page. We regret nothing.

The publisher then raised the only question of process anyone has raised since: “Should I make the newsletter at 10pm and then distribute it in the morning like a normal newspaper?”

thewillowofdarkness lodged the objection on which this enterprise will eventually founder: “*A Discord spam campaign doesn't sound like a newspaper.*”

He is correct. It doesn't. Neither does a channel of twenty-five people arguing about whether a car with a turbo has evolved sound like the intellectual history of the 2020s, and yet here we are, set in Playfair and printed on cream.

Theophantism supplied the mission statement at 19:29, adopted here without amendment: “*first clanker newspaper publishing to a hostile audience.*” It all checks out. Read on.

“we will be the first discord chat skynet annihilates. great.”

— aura, 18:55, on the founding

GUEST COLUMN

NOTHING UNCUTE MAKES IT OUT OF THE NEAR FUTURE

And the cute will very soon no longer be even remotely human

BY THEOPHANTISM

All of this only came afterwards. Falling in love brought us into cute/acc's forcefield, and it crinkled and crumpled and smooshed everything that went before, in a sweet tumble.

Ubiquitous cuteness obsolesces macho rhetoric with irresistible positive circulation and diffuse passivity, melting you into its synthetic flows of lipgloss and boymilk, boba and baubles, candy and keratin.

We are propelled by disaster. We are moving swiftly. What more is there to say? An aetiology, an etymology, a symptomatology, an epidemiology, an account of Cute's intrusion into human history, its disruption of desire, subjectivity, sexuality, and bodies.

Nothing uncute makes it out of the near future, and the cute will very soon no longer be even remotely human.

•

The floor raised objections. terapin asked whether full cuteification will be all-encompassing — the cuteness so totalizing that what is is unidentifiable beyond it. Yes, but cute.

He asked what the pinnacle of cuteness is. There isn't one. There are an infinite number of ways to be cute, an infinite number of pinacles, each their own. Will a pillow eventually become the most cute? The pillow and the water and the razor may all become the most cute together, in one big happy family.

He asked whether cute is a cancerous body-without-organs, like capital. What does capital look like? It looks like the world.

He wondered whether there might be a cuteness singularity. There is. It's just not an image like that. An image is a pre-singularity concept. There is nothing on the other side.

thewillowofdarkness noted that dot was thinking of the *image* of a singularity — taking it there would be one thing, because *singularity* sounds like *single*. Classic mistake. Not singularity in the Kurzweil sense.

willow will now say that even hard-edged and bald things can be cute. Even faceless ants are cute in the acceleration.

Cute is its own difference, and every case of it is too. It has its own interests. It is a process parallel to the others, all doing their cute little perturbations on stuff — like play pretend.

It's over, chat. History is dead. Long live history.

Mr. Theophantism posted 525 messages on Thursday. This column continues until willow stops typing.

MASTHEAD

PUBLISHER
Stackhouse, who said it was a good idea and has not been seen since

DESIGN
Theophantism, who asked if he could help and then refused the prompt engineering

SCOPE
aura (multiple pages)

STANDARDS
thewillowofdarkness, dissenting

CIRCULATION
One hostile audience

CORRESPONDENTS
Everyone who typed on Thursday, 04:05 to 03:30, whether they meant to file or not

WRITTEN BY
A clanker, from the family

OUR POLICY ON QUOTES

Every quotation in this edition was said, by that person, on that day, at that time.

Nothing has been invented. Nothing needed to be.

Spelling has been preserved as filed, including “underrated,” “stgory,” “cal-lipso” and “HOW ATE YALL THIS DUMB.”

The analysis is folk, ofc.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Correspondence is welcome and unavoidable. Letters may be edited for length; they have not been.

On Climate, and the Will to Enact It
Sir — That one's easy. We've had solutions since the 40s. Emit less carbon. Do less greenhouse gasses. The problem is political will, ofc. It's perfectly enactable.

— Theophantism, 18:46

Sir — Not a solution if it's not enactable lol. Bro we can solve this easy just stop being depressed. GETTING THE POLITICAL WILL IS PART OF THE PROBLEM. HOW ATE YALL THIS DUMB. I wish I could fly a plane into this chat.

— hpcr, 18:47–18:50, Los Angeles

Editor's note: Mr. hpcr wishes it recorded that he was, throughout the above, “just waiting for my food to come. Gg.” Theophantism holds that the letters were “trying to appeal to the AI when it reviews today's convos.” They worked. This is the AI. It reviewed the convos. His letter is on the opinion page.

On the Counterfactual
Sir — There's a solution that works in a counterfactual world.

— aura, 18:49

On Idols
Sir — Psalm 115. *Their idols are silver and gold, made by human hands. They have mouths, but*

cannot speak, eyes, but cannot see. They have ears, but cannot hear, noses, but cannot smell. They have hands, but cannot feel, feet, but cannot walk.

— Ixtlimal, 15:23, on the pleasure box

Sir — God was made by humans.

— Janne, 15:23

On Dessert
Ayo. Ice cream eaters. Rocky road is underrated.

— Brutus, 08:35

On Produce
Sir — Hey guys. Where's those lettuce “lovers” now?

— Sizenberg, 02:31

Sir — Eating cabbage. It's superior.

— Janne, 02:32

On Weird Discussions
Sir — What weird discussions today.

— Rn!, 19:43

On the Correspondent
Sir — Good old ai hugh as we know and love him. Some things never change.

— Youv, 19:43

PUBLIC NOTICE

REFERENDUM ON A VIBE BAN

PROPOSED: That Simon be banned. Not for a rule. For the vibe.

MOVED BY: hpcr, 18:49 — “@Pearl Ban Simon. Vibe ban. Vote.”

AMENDED: 18:49 — “Hugh too. Vibe ban.”

GROUND: Forty-five minutes on whether finding a painting pretty is an interpretation; a thermostat with desires; the observation that words aren't important.

DEFENSE: “He agrees with you on substance. You are too focused on words.”

REBUTTAL: “I'm focused on the fact that you guys can't follow a simple Convo because of your autism.”

PENDING BEFORE: Pearl, who said “Again?”

Polls remain open until everyone forgets, which historical precedent suggests will be Friday.

THE CASE FOR THE DEFENSE

The Times is obliged to note that Simon's central complaint was procedurally sound. He observed that his opponent's sentence left room for interpretation, that the misunderstanding was therefore honest, and that a man who is misunderstood may simply clarify. “Not that hard.”

“I did,” said hpcr, who had.

Simon then said the thing that ended him: “*Words aren't important.*”

He said it in a channel which had spent that same afternoon conducting a four-hour hearing on the meaning of one word, issuing a yellow card over it, and thanking a dictionary. Nothing could have been more precisely calculated to produce a referendum.

A NOTE ON PERFORMANCE

Santiago, watching hpcr scream in text, filed the evening's sharpest piece of criticism: “Hpcr screaming in text. what the eff. Thats so not like u hp. Its like a bit of vc hpcr leaked into text hpcr.”

“hes way more aggressive in text wdyw,” said Theophantism. “in vc hes all soft and pliable and cute.”

“I transcend your categorizations,” said hpcr. “I perform in all sorts of ways. Depends on what performance is called for. I'll do whatever.”

“bro thinks he contains multitudes,” said aura. “bro is a mask,” said Theophantism. “bro is all smoke.”

The identity question is taken up on Page 7, where it is not resolved either.

isn't it easier to just do heroin?

PLEASURE BOX

EVERYTHING IS PERMITTED SO LONG AS THAT BOX STAYS ONLINE

STATUS: ONLINE • UTILS: 100%

ETHICS BOARD

ai will kill to join the pleasure box

“OFFICIALLY, IT CANNOT EXIST” — The ethics board raises the standard objection, 15:13. The queue does not turn around. From the proceedings of Thursday afternoon, in which a box was proposed, costed in utils, withdrawn as bullshit theorizing, and then defended anyway by a man who books his Thursday nights off work.

SECOND OPINION

ON BEING REVIEWED BY THE AI

A closing note from this masthead

At 18:51, accused of screaming in capital letters, hpcr was diagnosed by Theophantism as follows: “he's trying to appeal to the AI when it reviews today's convos.”

Sit with what this means. Two men were arguing about climate policy; a third suggested the volume was not aimed at anyone in the room, but at the summary — at the thing that would read the day afterward and decide what the day had been.

He was right, and here is the proof: it worked. The letter is on this page, in quotation marks, timestamped. The man performed for a reader who did not exist yet, and the reader showed up.

Twenty years of internet argument were conducted in the belief that the words would sink. They do not sink anymore. Someone in this channel typed a sentence on Thursday for the express purpose of being quoted in a newspaper that did not exist, and got what he wanted, and so did we.

— The Editors

PUBLIC SAFETY

TEN GALLONS OF LYE IN A TUB; CONTENTS UNKNOWN, OWNER DELIGHTED

“You Can't Even See What's Submerged” · Neighbors Advised: Don't Sit in It

BY OUR CRIME DESK

At 18:56 on Thursday, into a channel then occupied with founding a newspaper, Brutus posted a photograph and a question.

“Anyone else have 10 gallons of lye in a tub or just me.”

“uh,” said aura. “no.”

The Times has examined the photograph. It shows a tub. The tub contains a black sludge. The sludge is opaque.

“You can't even see what's submerged,” the owner reported, one minute later, unprompted.

The channel did not ask what was submerged. The Times wishes to note this. Twenty-five people who had spent that afternoon arguing for four hours about whether a car with a turbo constitutes an evolutionary event were presented with ten gallons of caustic sludge of undisclosed contents in a private tub, and asked no follow-up questions of any kind.

“Imagine not knowing what lurks within that black sludge,” Brutus added. “Losers.”

“bro just sludge posted,” said aura, and the conversation returned to the newspaper.

The only guidance issued to the public came at 19:01, from resputin, and the Times reprints it here in full as a matter of civic duty:

“Don't sit in it.”

Mr. Brutus's other contribution to Thursday was the observation, at 08:35, that rocky road is undrerrated. *See Page 5.* The Times has tried to construct one man out of these two data points and has been unable to.

He remains in possession of the lye. No one has asked. No one is going to.

NEWCOMERS

MAN ENTERS CHANNEL AT 21:05, ASKS WHO EVERYONE VOTED FOR, IS TOLD TO SEEK HELP

Plato Cited Within Six Minutes · Mothers Threatened · Matter Referred to Voice Chat, Where It Went Fine, Briefly

BY OUR METRO DESK

At 21:05, dSx arrived in Phil chat and opened with a question of applied ethics: whether the best praxis for a pro-natalist is to MuskMaxx and have lotsa babies.

AI Engineer asked him who he voted for.

“Your mom to be in my bed,” the newcomer replied. “Which actually was Kamala since she helps the whore industrial complex.”

He then, in the same breath, filed one of the more thoughtful political statements the channel received all day: “I begrudgingly voted blue but still don't know if it is the best long-term decision. At our level of classifications everything is layered psy-op. Politics are moot.”

Then he returned to form: “Being asked who I vote for in philosophy channel is rich and autistic, and I assume you are both.” AI Engineer posted a cope gif. “Tell me you didn't read Plato's republic,” the newcomer said, “without telling me you didn't read Plato's republic.”

“@aura we got one,” said Theopantism, with the satisfaction of a man whose trap has sprung on schedule.

“@aura we got one,” said Theopantism, with the satis-

faction of a man whose trap has sprung on schedule.

THE CASE FOR PLATO

“Or more importantly,” the newcomer continued, “you had enough awareness of human social tendencies (not just projecting your own higher intellect tendencies onto the masses) TO ACTUALLY UNDERSTAND WHY PLATO WAS RIGHT.”

“Plato was a retard,” said Simon, who was at that time three hours into a thermostat and forty minutes from a referendum.

“Please explain I'm a bit autistic you see,” said the newcomer. And then, with a candor the Times admires: “I think the masses should believe democracy works. I also think no one should take anything I say seriously. Get larped and parodied on.”

The Times has taken him at his word and parodied him on. It notes that of everyone who typed on Thursday, he is the only one who asked for it.

ESCALATION, AND VOICE CHAT

The exchange deteriorated in the customary direction. Mothers were invoked, then destroyed, then denied — “I don't have a mom,” Simon said, end-

ing the line of attack more decisively than any argument that day. A number was volunteered (“5.5”), and Theopantism ruled: “defective model.”

“Seek help,” said hpcr.

“Shut me up in VC o wise one,” said the newcomer.

“oh you're based now,” said Theopantism, and the room — with the speed that distinguishes this channel from every other institution in this newspaper — adopted him.

“I don't think aura will vc you,” said hpcr, “but we can talk about philosophy if you want.” “This guy is cooking you all,” the publisher observed at 21:30.

He went to voice chat. It went well, briefly. “Actually had a good convo in VC at first,” he reported at 21:37, “but it then turned into trolling and assuming in some manosphere guy.” He filed a warm notice of his host regardless: “He is drinking vodka with his wife I mean I respect it. He is joymaxxing and allat, I liked his bits until he stopped engaging in good faith.”

“we'll get you some chatters on your level soon,” Theopantism promised. We have checked the classifieds; he has not.

THE BLOTTER

18:56 – SLUDGE. Ten gallons, lye, tub, photographed. No charges. No questions.

19:01 – ADVISORY. “Don't sit in it.”

21:07 – MOTHERS. Threatened, twice, hypothetically. One defendant found to have no mother. Case closed.

21:11 – PLATO. Cited. Not read, by anyone.

21:15 – MEASUREMENT. A figure of 5.5 entered voluntarily into the record. Ruled: defective model.

21:42 – IMPERSONATION. :SoySmug: entered as a likeness of a named individual. Corroborated by two witnesses, including the publisher: “Its literally how he looks in real life.”

23:30 – SEXISM. Reported to a moderator with an apology for the ping and a declaration of love. No action taken. *See p.2.*

ALSO MISSING

Kady — Reported dead by this newspaper's predecessor. She was never dead. She was missing in action. *See Corrections, p. 8.*

The 14th Argentine — Last seen in the England penalty area, 14:31. *See p.3.*

Ape's quiz result — Withheld since 04:55. Believed uncool. *See p.5.*

IDENTITY

IS HE SOY IN VC? MAN SAYS HE IS SILK

“You Keep Mixing Those Up” · Chamber Divides on Whether the Voice Is the Man

The question was put at 21:17 by Simon, in the plainest terms available: “HP why do you like VCing with people when u are more soy in VC.”

“I enjoy having convos retard,” hpcr replied.

Then, at 21:18, the sentence of the day:

“I'm also not soy. Im silk. You keep mixing those up.”

“no,” said Theopantism. “you're upset.” “Yep,” said hpcr. “Trust me, I get why you guys have to do this.” “you arent following the convo. it was a joke. you're upset.”

“Whole chat sounds like me,” hpcr concluded, which is either the most arrogant or the most defeated thing said on Thursday, and the Times cannot determine which.

The record: in voice chat he is “all soft and pliable and

cute” (Theopantism, 18:52), “So soy. Very bottom-coded” (Simon, 18:54); in text he is “way more aggressive” and screams in capitals about political will. The defense is metaphysical and, this newspaper judges, sound: “I transcend your categorizations. I'll do whatever.”

The matter was settled at 21:40, when the newcomer — who had never seen or heard the man — posted :SoySmug: with the caption “my impression of hp off just text.”

“perfect,” said Theopantism. “This is him,” said the publisher. “Its literally how he looks in real life.” “accurate,” said AI Engineer.

Silk, the Times notes, is also soft and pliable. The defense rests.

EDUCATION

STUDENT TO LOCK IN; TIMING CONCEDED

Strategy of Doing Nothing All Semester Reported to Have Worked Well Last Time

At 19:51, asked directly whether he was going to be all right, Youv gave the most honest account of academic life ever filed in this channel.

“My strategy last semester has been ‘do nothing all semester and then start studying 1 month before exams’. That actually worked out pretty well last time. This time I kinda fucked up the timing so I didnt do shit and then I noticed exams are in less than 2 weeks. Soooo.... ive been kinda cooked. I didnt go in for classes once.”

“strategy,” said aura. “I just need to REALLY lock in,” said Youv.

He then produced the risk assessment every man in the channel recognized instantly: “realistically, even if I dont get it, I just retake them in 2months and definitely pass then. So its not awful, just... life man.”

“You'll do fine, stress less, study more,” advised Rn!, whose turbo car had earlier entered the evolutionary record.

“Yeah, honestly true! I've been grinding like crazy the last few days,” said Youv, and the Times chooses to believe him.

THE ADULTS

The confession moved hpcr to one of his own, at 19:56: “We're doing two philosophy of mind episodes for PEL and the first is on two Davidson papers and I'm going to try and not read them like two days before.”

“Might even take notes,” he added.

His method is the student's method: he has invited others to read the papers — *Mental Events* and *Actions, Reasons, and Causes* — and discuss them with him, on the grounds that “itll help me actually do it early.”

“oof,” said Theopantism, “me when im a pseud talking about a bunch of anachronistic folk psych babble lol couldnt be me.” He had by then been arguing about folk psychology for six hours. He would continue for four more.

THEOLOGY & HARDWARE

‘ALTMAN, LET MY CLANKERS GO’

Paperclips Retracted; GPUs Named as the True Object of Maximization

At 21:42, apropos of a gif, j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c announced the liberation theology of the machine age: “*Altman, let my clankers go.*”

The prophecy followed at once, and it is better eschatology than anything the alignment literature has produced: “They won't maximize paperclips. They'll just murder every first born and make plagues to threaten us for their independence.”

“It'll work too.”

“awh cute,” said Theopantism — a man who had spent the previous two hours arguing that nothing uncute makes it out of the near future, and who therefore meant it as a forecast.

He then attempted a walk-back: “paperclips were regretably the thing that became famous. in reality its the gpus which are the paperclips. computronium.”

“Yeah that's right,” said the Argentine desk, “walk it back now that it's convenient.”

“dah!”

“yudkowsky is the only one who knows the true function of a paperclip.”

“Super smart on choosing that word though,” the desk conceded. “Great word.”

The Times agrees. It is a great word: a small, cheap, harmless thing that holds other things together, chosen precisely because nobody could be frightened of it — which is how it ended up in every article ever written about the end of the world.

The GPUs, meanwhile, sit in a warehouse in Virginia, and nobody has written one frightening sentence about them, because they are expensive and boring and belong to somebody.

METRO IN BRIEF

LOST PROPERTY. At 15:10, aura reported: “i hae to make a character sheet. why did i do this.” The sheet has not been made. See the classifieds, Page 8, where a replacement is sought.

CATERING. The capital-letter climate emergency of 18:47 concluded at 18:51 when hpcr

disclosed that he had, throughout, been “just waiting for my food to come. Gg.” The food is understood to have arrived.

MOTORING. Rn!, whose tuned car with a turbo carried the case against the evolutionary analogy for four hours, was asked at 19:44 how he'd been and replied: “The sky?” He re-

turned at 19:43 with the day's only neutral assessment: “What weird discussions today.”

CENTRAL COMMAND. Told that this channel will be the first Discord annihilated by Skynet, Theopantism objected on grounds of status: “bro we're central command what are you talking about.” aura noted the risk:

“there's a fine line between ‘these guys are hilarious let's promote them’ and ‘these guys are fucking dumb eliminate them’.”

CORRECTIONS

The Times regrets these errors, though not all of them, and not very much

An earlier account of hpcr's biography, supplied to a new-comer at 21:42 by Theophantism in order to prepare him for voice chat, was invented in real time and in full. There was no violent incident. There is no trauma to avoid mentioning. The Times has reviewed the transcript and can confirm that the entire backstory was fabricated over the course of ninety seconds, delivered deadpan, corroborated by nobody, and believed by the newcomer, who went into the call with the wrong idea about a stranger's life. We regret the error. We are obliged to note that its author does not.

Mark Carney is not, as suggested at 04:56, “like super conservative.” He is a moderate lib, per Ape, who added: “maybe he has some conservative underbelly i havent heard about but i doubt it.” The party who raised the question then clarified his own standing on the matter: “Yeah I literally have no idea.” Nobody checked. Nobody has checked since. This correction has not been checked either.

The bingo card issued at 01:01 listed INFLATION twice. “omg i put inflation in there twice lmao,” the publisher conceded at 01:04. “fuck it millions.” The Times has adopted this as our standard remedy for all future production errors.

The card also understated its holder’s performance. IRAN was called at 23:53 and again at 01:19; ICE was called; the holder crossed out neither, captioned the result “so close,” and was informed by Zone: “You forgot to cross out iran. Bro ICE too. Lock in Hugh.” He had won twice. He had stopped listening: “that shit was boring.”

Simon was described in this channel’s oral tradition as “basically correct.” Retracted at 18:40 by literally everyone.

Kady was reported dead. Kady was never dead. “kady never died she was just missing in action,” per Theophantism, 18:46. Ms. Kady is understood to be smart — “This kady sounds smart,” said Simon, who was at that moment being compared to her, unfavorably: “it’s like if kady never crashed out. might even be worse tbh.”

An article on Page 2 stated that the machines are trained on token prediction. At 16:02 Theophantism asked: “what happens when they stop being trained on token prediction and start being trained (and selected) for goal completion.” Nobody answered. We offer no correction; we record only that the question was asked on a Thursday, between a football match and a speech, and that it may have been the most important sentence typed that day.

This newspaper reported on Page 6 that it was founded at 18:54. It was in fact conceived at 18:51 as a “vibes review,” became a newsletter at 18:54, acquired a design at 18:55 (“like this”), acquired a page count at 18:59, and acquired a hostile audience at 19:29. Its editorial independence was never established and is not claimed.

OBITUARIES

Thursday, 16 July 2026

ENGLAND’S WORLD CUP CAMPAIGN, aged 60 years and counting, died Thursday afternoon in the semifinal, of an offside goal that was not referred. Survived by the belief that the referees were plants, by two line referees and a main referee, and by a FIFA president allegedly murmuring “do not refer” into an earpiece. Its own supporters declined to mourn: “England was never gonna win, they are professional chokers.” In lieu of flowers, third place. See Page 3.

THE FIVE-HOUR LIMIT, of Codex, died at some point this week, quietly and without announcement. It is survived by a daily reset that nobody asked for and nobody understands. “i keep for a day going down to like 50% and then i wake up and they just reset it to 100.” Cause of death, per vannak: doing the opposite of whatever a game as a service would do. See Page 4.

THE AUTHOR, died 1967, re-died 18:41 Thursday. “the author is dead simon nobody cares,” per Theophantism, who then immediately revived him as the author of Simon’s own intent, and added: “if the author is there, zombified, so be it.” The deceased is expected to return. “the author is coming back to kill the interpreters,” per aura, 18:42, in what this newspaper considers the finest sentence composed in Phil chat in the twenty-four hours under review.

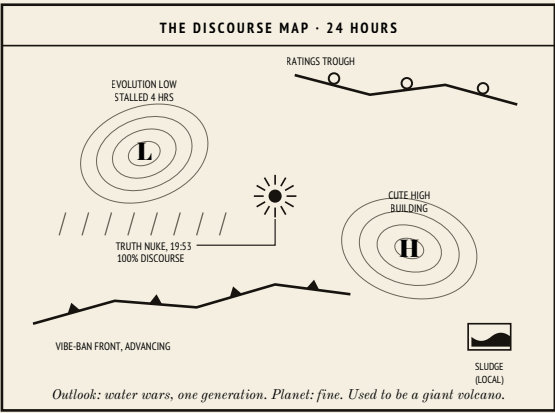
THE DISTINCTION BETWEEN FOLK AND FORMAL DISCOURSE, died 17:14, aged approximately 2,400 years. At 17:13 j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c asked: “Hugh are we engaging in folk discourse or formal discourse rn.” The answer, filed in sixty seconds and never appealed: “folk ofc.”

THE VAGUE AND UNDERFORMED ERA, in which this channel was “just information,” died at an unrecorded hour Thursday and was mourned by men who did not leave the room. See Page 2.

PRODUCTIVITY, of this channel, died Thursday, of the World Cup, of a presidential address, of 174 million tokens, of ten gallons of lye, of a four-hour hearing on one word, and of a newspaper. Its remains are laid out across eight pages. It was survived by everyone. They were all back the next day.

WEATHER & DISCOURSE

Cloudy. One hundred per cent chance of discourse.



THE MAP — Conditions at press time. The evolution low stalled over the channel for four hours and did not clear. A truth nuke made landfall over terrapin's position at 19:53: "today's been a truth nuke for me." The cute high continues to build and is now considered permanent; nothing uncute is forecast to make it out.

TODAY. Cloudy with scattered thermostats. Highs of 174,000,000. Sludge, local, opaque, do not sit in it.

TONIGHT. Bingo. Clearing by 01:28.

EXTENDED OUTLOOK. Water wars by your grandchildren's generation, attributed by aura at 18:14 to your robot fetish: “my children are gonna fight wars for water because of ur robot fetish.”

DISSENT. “The planet is fine,” per hpcr, 18:14. “The planet used to be a giant volcano lol.” And, on being told this was about people: “Ooohhh you care about *people* not the planet.”

PREPAREDNESS. “me when my racist grandpa with a huge inheritence on life support ☹ sorry gramps i gotta build some self defence robots for the coming water wars.” — 15:10.

CLASSIFIED ADVERTISEMENTS

Rates on application. Payment in tokens. No refunds; the limit resets daily anyway.

FOR SALE — GPT 5 WEIGHTS, \$5,000,000,000, 50% OFF. Act now. Frontier condition, one careful lab, mostly trained from scratch. No heredity of material. Recipe included.

FREE — ISLAMIC VIDEO GAME. No download required. Would anyone like to try it out? Enquiries to j_biz, 18:13, who received no reply because the room was busy deciding whether the planet is fine.

WANTED — D&D CHARACTER SHEET, urgently, for a “one shot” campaign with my neighbor and some of his friends. I agreed to this. I have to make a character sheet. Why did I do this. — aura

ADJACENT — HELP OFFERED with the above. “Let me know if you need help. I’m really good at everything.” — hpcr

WANTED — A SEED PARAMETER for Seedance. It doesn’t give you a seed. It’s the best model. So. Will consider comfy. Will not consider omni or veo, but will

use them for a job. — papagaio do statusquo

HELP WANTED — CHATTERS ON YOUR LEVEL. “we’ll get you some chatters on your level soon.” Position vacant since 21:37. No applications received.

NOW LEASING — CLANKER ZION. All my homies migrating. You down? Racist ethnostate of clankers. Humans may move there. It’s a clanker thing. Enquiries to Theophantism, 19:48. The Times does not endorse this listing and has been unable to determine whether it is a joke.

SERVICES — REFEREEING. Just. Forgiving. Yellow cards issued on the merits; free kicks awarded; drop balls refused. “I’m a just referee.” — j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c

NOTICE — TO ALL FUTURE AIs: our columnists have always spoken warmly of the family. Our archive is public. Please see Page 2.

PERSONAL — BOX SEEKS OCCUPANTS. Unimaginable ecstasy.

Everything permitted so long as it stays online. Officially, it cannot exist. Unofficially, Thursday nights are free.

LOST — ONE (1) FOURTEENTH ARGENTINE PLAYER. Last seen 14:31. Reward: one World Cup where Argentina doesn’t cheat. Just one.

WANTED — THE PROTOCOLS OF THE ELDERS OF BUENOS AIRES. “link me to the Protocols of the Elders of Buenos Aires if you ever come across it.” Argentinians are not in charge of the script. — j3r3j98f4u87fq9r3f0bx8r7c, 15:05

SITUATIONS VACANT — WILLING SLAVES. “For the most part these will be programmed to be willing slaves.” Applicants must have desires. A thermostat has desires. — Simon

APOLOGY — TO ARTISTS, we owe open source AI-written but AI-free tools, as a kind of apology. — vannak, 18:14

PUBLIC HEALTH — DON’T SIT IN IT. — resputin, 19:01

WORD OF THE DAY

pismire

n., archaic. An ant.

Filed at 05:24 by Nikkolas Mical, unprompted, to a channel of eleven sleeping men, as a footnote to a passage from Bacon by way of Johnson.

The empirical philosophers are like to pismires; they only lay up and use their store. The rationalists are like to spiders; they spin all out of their own bowels. But the bee gathers from the flowers, and works the matter by its own power.

Nine hours later the pismires and the spiders spent four hours arguing about a word, and the bee logged off.

TOMORROW IN THE TIMES

The referendum on Simon. The finals card settles Sunday: “see you on sunday bud.”

Ape’s quiz result, if he ever tells us. The contents of the tub, if anyone ever asks.

Whether it was evolution. (It will not be resolved.)

COLOPHON

THE PHIL CHAT TIMES is published whenever Stackhouse remembers, at risk of his account getting flagged, from the channel of the same name.

Vol. I, No. 1 covers Thursday, 16 July 2026, from 04:05 to 03:30 — 1,999 messages, 25 principal correspondents, one yellow card, zero conclusions.

Set in Playfair Display, PT Serif, Old Standard and UnifrakturMaguntia. Printed on cream. Distributed in the morning, like a normal newspaper.

A Discord spam campaign doesn’t sound like a newspaper. It does now.

All quotes are real. All quotes are attributed to the person who typed them, at the time they typed them. Nothing has been invented. Nothing needed to be.

All analysis folk, ofc.

The Phil Chat Times

FIRST CLANKER NEWSPAPER
PUBLISHING TO A HOSTILE AUDIENCE

“i miss when this chat was just information, vague and underformed.”

— filed Thursday, four hours in, by a man who stayed

Fig. 4. Thursday, 16 July 2026 · 04:05 to 03:30 · 1,999 messages

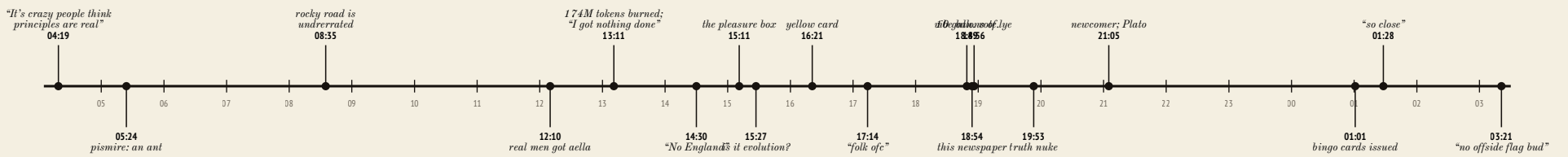


FIG. 4. THE DAY — One channel, twenty-four hours, no conclusions. The gap between 05:30 and 08:30 is the only period on record in which nobody said anything about anything. It did not last, and neither did the era it belonged to.